CITY OF SYDNEY

Housing Audit

June 2024



Housing Audit

The City of Sydney acknowledges the Gadigal of the Eora Nation as the Traditional Custodians of our local area.

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Background

The City of Sydney Housing Data Collection Framework provides a comprehensive method for the audit of all housing (building) and dwelling stock in the local area. This provides an estimate of all types of residential buildings, dwelling structure, and dwelling tenure. The audit of the housing and dwelling stock in the City of Sydney local area will be reported annually at the end of each financial year.

The Housing Audit's data is sourced from the City of Sydney Floor Space and Employment Survey (the most recent Survey was undertaken in 2022/23). Annual updates are augmented by information collected from monitoring of development statistics and changes to ownership patterns, and data gathered from housing providers. The data considers both additions (new dwellings) and subtractions (demolished dwellings, change of use) to obtain net increase and end of year totals for housing and dwellings.

The City of Sydney local area has undergone a rapid increase in dwelling stock over the past decade, with more new dwellings due for completion in both the near and medium terms. There are currently 12,113 private dwellings and 4,128 non-private dwellings in the City's development pipeline, due for completion over the next five years. The Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) Estimated Resident Population (ERP) for the City of Sydney local area at June 2023 was 231,086 (*Australian Bureau of Statistics (2022-23), Regional population, ABS Website, accessed 17 October 2024*).

The City's Community Strategic Plan (*Sustainable Sydney 2030-2050 Continuing the Vision*) contains 10 strategic directions aimed at delivering a city the community wants by 2036. Strategic Direction 10 – Housing for all – aims for "… a city where everyone has a home. Social, affordable, and supported housing is available for those who need it. High-quality housing is available for everyone".

In the City's Community Strategic Plan, Target 6 states that by 2036:

"**By 2036 there will be at least 156,000 private dwellings** and 17,500 non-private dwellings that include boarding houses and student accommodation. Of the private dwellings, **7.5% will be social housing and 7.5% will be affordable housing** with this proportion maintained into the future."

The figures quoted in the Community Strategic Plan relate to private and non-private dwellings as defined by the ABS. The term private dwelling applies to all housing except for boarding houses (Class 1B and Class 3), student accommodation and residential care services (such as aged-care facilities). Private housing includes social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing, and privately owned or rented housing.

The June 2024 Housing Audit provides a comprehensive data set for the assessment of all housing stock and housing types in the city.

The Housing Audit reports annually on the following:

- The city's current dwelling stock (buildings and dwellings)
  - private dwellings
  - non-private dwellings
- number of dwellings by Village area
- building structure
- dwelling structure including net annual increase
- dwelling tenure (type) including net annual increase

The 2024 Housing Audit also includes information on median income for City residents (Census data) and median rents (Department of Communities and Justice (formerly Housing) data).

Housing at June 2024

Building and dwelling stock

As of June 2024, it is estimated that there were 22,144 buildings in the City of Sydney local area that contain residential dwellings (either private or non-private dwellings).

Within these buildings there were a total of 140,376 residential dwellings counted.

There were 124,010 private dwellings (private ownership and rental dwellings, social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing).

There were 16,366 non-private dwellings (boarding house rooms, student accommodation rooms, residential care services).

Dwelling location, totals and net change, year to June 2024

The following tables show the numbers of private, non-private and total dwellings at June 2023 and June 2024, with net change in dwellings and percentage change in dwellings over the financial year.

Table 1. Private dwellings at 30 June 2024 by village

Village	Private Dwellings (private ownership and rental dwellings, social (including public) housing, affordable and rental housing)			
	Jun-23	Jun-24	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	6,348	6,346	-2	0.0%
Chinatown & CBD South	9,521	9,495	-26	-0.3%
Crown & Baptist Streets	13,140	13,081	-59	-0.4%
Glebe Point Road	12,478	12,443	-35	-0.3%
Green Square and City South	22,652	23,844	1,192	5.3%
Harris Street	9,155	9,157	2	0.0%
King Street	10,782	10,794	12	0.1%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	13,080	13,088	8	0.1%
Oxford Street	11,004	11,065	61	0.6%
Redfern Street	14,563	14,697	134	0.9%
City of Sydney local area	**122,723**	**124,010**	**1,287**	**1.0%**

Table 2. Non-private dwellings at 30 June 2024 by village

Village	Non-private Dwellings (boarding house rooms, student accommodation rooms, residential care services)			
	Jun-23	Jun-24	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	17	17	0	0.0%
Chinatown & CBD South	1,473	1,449	-24	-1.6%
Crown & Baptist Streets	1,129	1,132	3	0.3%
Glebe Point Road	1,982	2,001	19	1.0%
Green Square and City South	19	19	0	0.0%
Harris Street	854	865	11	1.3%
King Street	3,719	3,823	104	2.8%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	360	380	20	5.6%
Oxford Street	1,139	1,133	-6	-0.5%
Redfern Street	5,169	5,547	378	7.3%
City of Sydney local area	**15,861**	**16,366**	**505**	**3.2%**

Table 3. Total dwellings (private and non-private) at 30 June 2024 by village

Village	Total Dwellings			
	Jun-23	Jun-24	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	6,365	6,363	-2	0.0%
Chinatown & CBD South	10,994	10,944	-50	-0.5%
Crown & Baptist Streets	14,269	14,213	-56	-0.4%
Glebe Point Road	14,460	14,444	-16	-0.1%
Green Square and City South	22,671	23,863	1,192	5.3%
Harris Street	10,009	10,022	13	0.1%
King Street	14,501	14,617	116	0.8%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	13,440	13,468	28	0.2%
Oxford Street	12,143	12,198	55	0.5%
Redfern Street	19,732	20,244	512	2.6%
City of Sydney local area	**138,584**	**140,376**	**1,792**	**1.3%**

There was a net increase of 1,287 private dwellings, 505 non-private dwellings (1,792 total dwellings) in the city in the past year. Net increase includes the addition of completed dwellings and the subtraction of demolished or replacement dwellings. Green Square and City South had both the highest net and proportional growth over the past year, with 1,192 additional dwellings and a 5.3% increase.

The highest number of private dwellings was in the Green Square and City South village (23,844). 92.6% of the net private dwelling increase for 2023/24 occurred in the Green Square and City South village.

Redfern Street village had the highest number of non-private dwellings (5,169). Non-private dwellings increased by 3.2% between June 2023 and June 2024, up to 16,366.

The dwelling targets for the Community Strategic Plan are for the city to have at least 156,000 (private) dwellings and 17,500 non-private dwellings by 2036. The baseline figures (June 2021) were 121,725 private dwellings and 15,127 non-private dwellings. The targets required additional 34,275 private dwellings at an average of 2,285 per annum, and 2,373 non-private dwellings at an average of 158 per annum between 2021 and 2036.

By June 2024 there were 124,010 private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, or 79.5% of the total private dwelling target for 2036. By June 2024 there were 16,366 non-private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, or 93.5% of the total non-private dwelling target for 2036.

There are 12,342 private dwellings and 4,775 non-private dwellings in the city's development pipeline (developments lodged, approved, or commenced construction).

The average net total dwelling increase over the past ten years was 3,746 dwellings per annum. This consisted of an average 2,919 private dwellings per annum and 827 non-private dwellings per annum.

Building structure

Approximately 97.7% of the building stock (22,145 total buildings) in the City of Sydney local area falls into four main types:

– terrace, town house and semi-detached buildings (78.0%)

– multi-storey apartment buildings (10.0%)

– separate (detached) houses (6.3%), and

– buildings with dwellings above shops (3.4%).

The other 2.3% of building stock comprises a mix of buildings containing residential care services, boarding house accommodation, student accommodation, or other dwelling types.

Dwelling structure

Of the 124,010 private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area at June 2024, 20,166 dwellings were terrace houses, comprising 16.3% of all private dwellings. A further 101,062 dwellings were in multi-storey apartment buildings, comprising 81.4% of all private dwellings.

There were also 1,475 separate (detached) dwellings and 1,005 dwellings located above shops in the City of Sydney local area. These comprised 1.2% and 0.8% of total private dwellings respectively.

There were 283 attached/granny flats included in the separate (detached) house (32), terrace, town house and semi-detached building (239), and buildings with dwellings above shops (12) totals.

The other 302 private dwellings include caretaker's and manager's flats, converted flats or other dwellings.

Additionally, there were 16,366 non-private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, including 3,482 boarding house rooms (21.3% of non-private dwellings), 12,120 student accommodation rooms (74.1% of non-private dwellings), and 764 other dwellings (4.7% of non-private dwellings). In 2023/24, an additional 406 student accommodation rooms were added to the city's non-private dwelling stock. 26 boarding house rooms were removed from the city's non-private dwelling stock.

During the 2023/24 financial year, there was a net increase of 1,792 (1.3%) total dwellings across the local area. The net dwelling stock increased by 1,287 private dwellings (1.0%) and 505 non-private dwellings (3.2%).

Dwelling tenure

The Housing Data Collection Framework classifies each individual residential unit or residential accommodation room by its tenure type or use. The main purpose of this section is to monitor the amount of social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing, boarding house accommodation and student accommodation in the City of Sydney.

As of June 2012, there were:

- 9,849 social (including public) housing dwellings,
- 619 affordable rental housing dwellings,
- 2,639 boarding house rooms, and
- 4,223 student accommodation rooms.

As of June 2024, there were:

- 9,538 social (including public) housing dwellings (down 3.2%)
- 1,260 affordable rental housing dwellings (up 103.6%)
- 3,482 boarding house rooms (up 31.9%), including
  - 1,471 Class 1b boarding house rooms (small dwellings with less than 12 persons)
  - 2,011 Class 3 boarding house rooms (larger buildings with higher levels of amenity), and
- 12,120 student accommodation rooms (up 187.0%).
- Additionally, there were 187 diverse[1] housing dwellings, made up of 52 private and 135 non-private dwellings.

At June 2024 social (including public) housing comprised 7.7% of the city's private dwelling stock (target is 7.5%).

At June 2024 affordable rental housing dwellings comprised 1.0% of the city's private dwelling stock (target is 7.5%).

In 2022 the *State Environmental Planning Policy (Housing) 2021* was enacted. The policy changed the definition of boarding houses and introduced definitions for of co-living housing (non-private), build-to-rent dwellings (private dwellings), and changes to the requirements for other types of dwellings. As developments of these types are completed in the city, they will be added to this report.

[1] Diverse Housing is any form of sub-market housing which caters for the particular housing needs of cohorts which may not be catered for by mainstream housing options, for example Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities, women and children leaving domestic and family violence and LGBTQIA+ communities. Diverse housing may combine particular support services with housing services or vary elements of service delivery to meet the needs of recipients.

Additional information

The following graph shows the ABS Estimated Resident Population (ERP) for the period June 2013 to June 2023. The current population of the city is 231,086 residents. The ERP was 17.7% higher in 2023 (231,086) compared to 2013 (196,318).

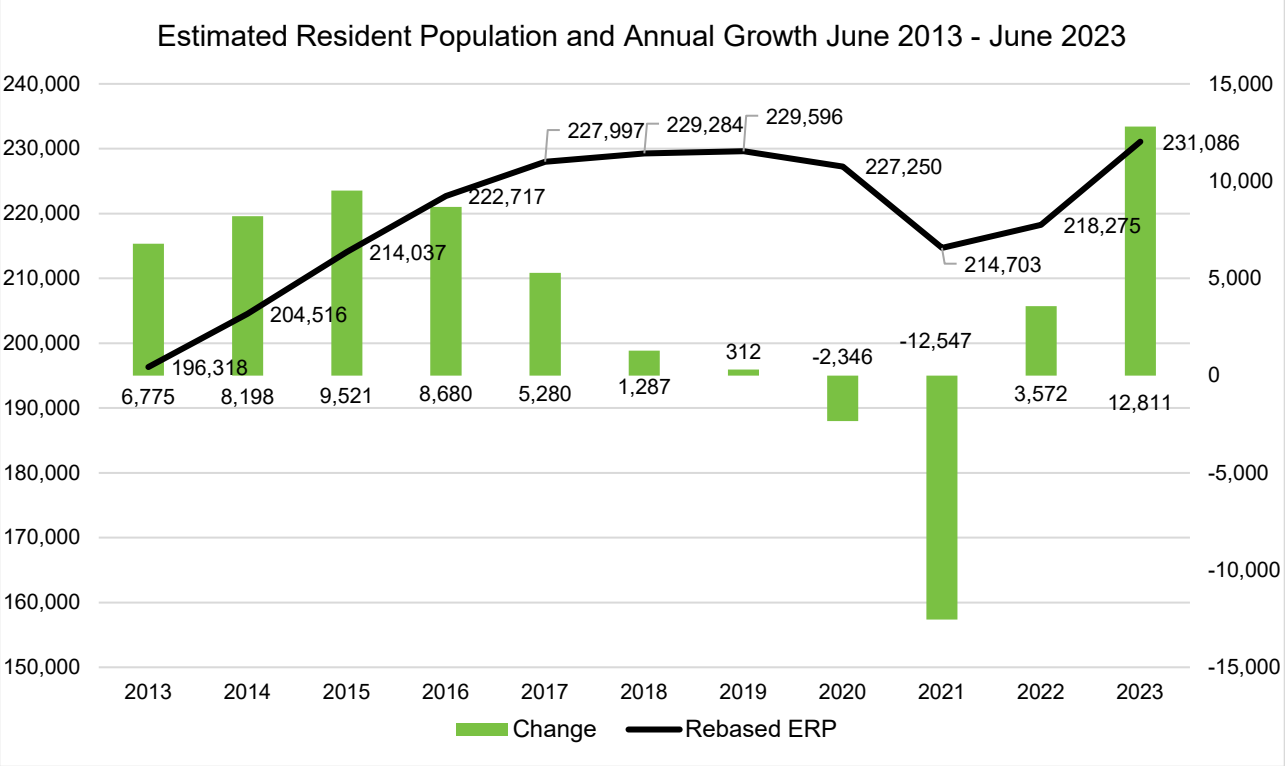


Figure 1. Estimated resident population and annual growth. Source: *ABS Regional Population*

Over the past five years the official population has increased by 1,802 persons. This includes a significant dip in population during the Covid-19 pandemic, when many residents left the city and were not replaced. At the same time 9,388 dwellings have been added to the city's total stock.

Between 2022 and 2023, our local area saw a net increase of 11,707 residents. During this period, 32,400 persons left the local area whilst 15,070 internal/domestic arrivals and 29,037 overseas arrivals settled into our local area. This means that our local area has a total of 44,107 new arrivals over the past year.

The Census results showed that the proportion of unoccupied dwellings rose from 11.8% in 2016 to 16.1% in 2021. The next Census is in August 2026.

As of June 2023, the City of Sydney local government area (LGA) was the 8th largest by population in metropolitan Sydney (8th in 2012 using current boundaries).

The ERP was released on 26 March 2024. The June 2024 ERP will be released on 27 March 2025.

The following graph shows the four-quarter average median sale price (in $'000s) for strata and non-strata properties over the ten years to 2023/24. Over this period, the median sale prices of strata properties (predominantly units) increased by 33.7%. Non-strata properties (predominantly terrace houses or separate dwellings) increased by 77.4%, despite a significant dip in 2019.

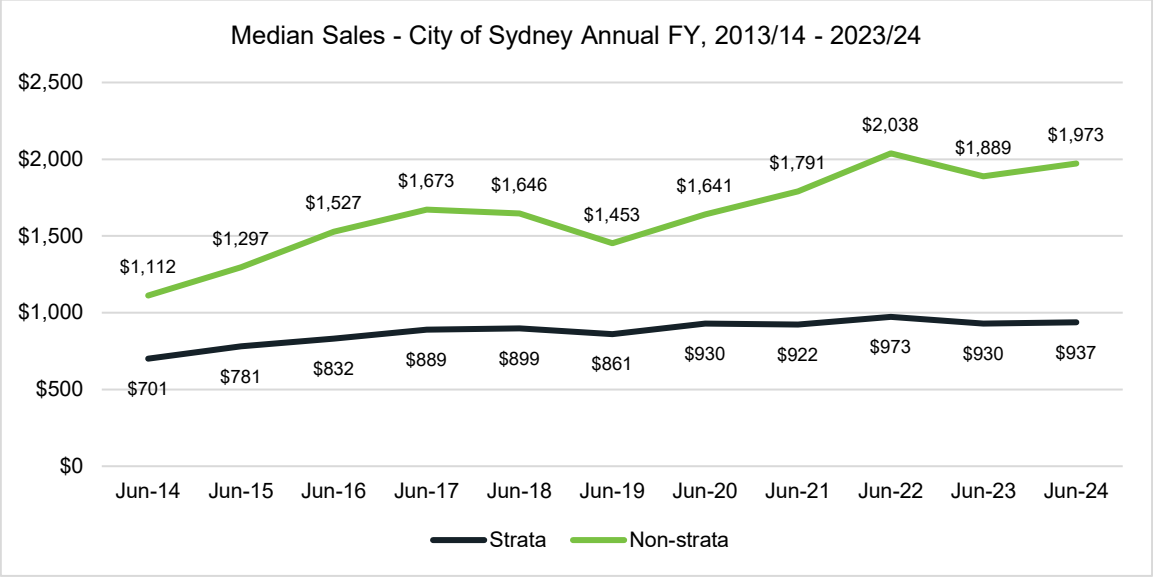


Figure 2. Median sale price, City of Sydney. Source: *NSW Department of Communities and Justice, Rent and Sales Report (Issues 106-149)*

The following graph shows the median rental price (four-quarter average) for new rental bonds of (two-bedroom) units and townhouses for the financial years between 2013/14 and 2023/24. Over this period, the median rental price of (two-bedroom) units increased by 33.6%. Rental prices for (two-bedroom) townhouses increased by 24.5%. Both median rental prices decreased during the Covid-19 pandemic but have risen significantly since then.

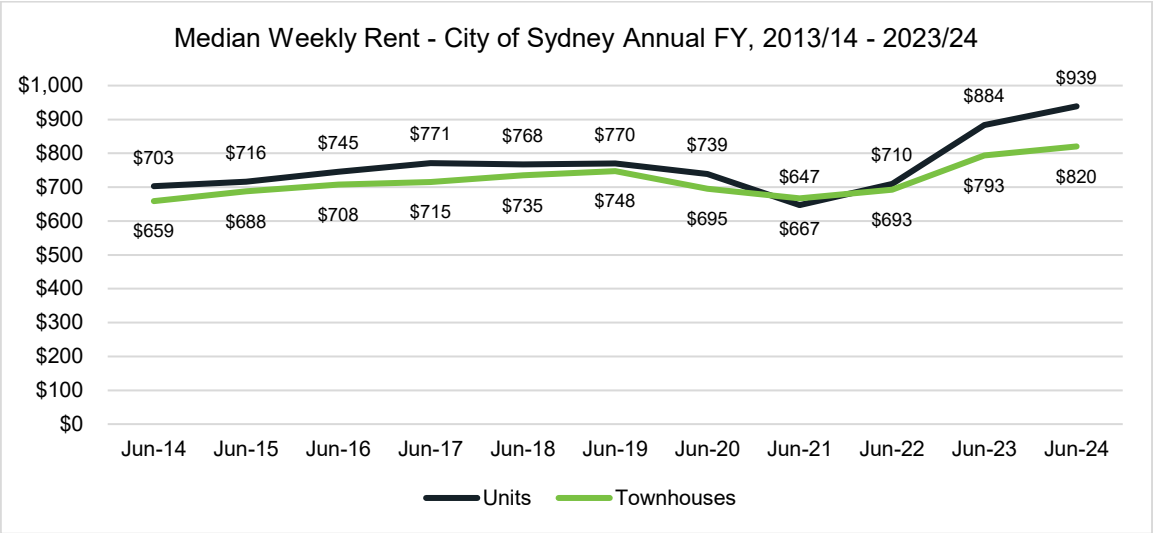


Figure 3. Median weekly rent, City of Sydney. Source: *NSW Department of Communities and Justice, Rent and Sales Report (Issues 105-148)*

Table 4. Selected medians and averages for City of Sydney, ABS Census 2011-2021

	2011	2016	2021
Median age of persons	32	32	34
Average number of persons per bedroom	1.1	1.2	1.1
Average household size	1.9	2.0	1.9

Table 4 shows selected medians from the past three ABS Censuses. The median age of residents in the City of Sydney local area remained relatively stable until 2021, when large numbers of international students and younger people moved out of the city during the Covid-19 pandemic. The flow-on effects have seen the average number of persons per bedroom and the average household size decrease, exacerbating the recent population decline.

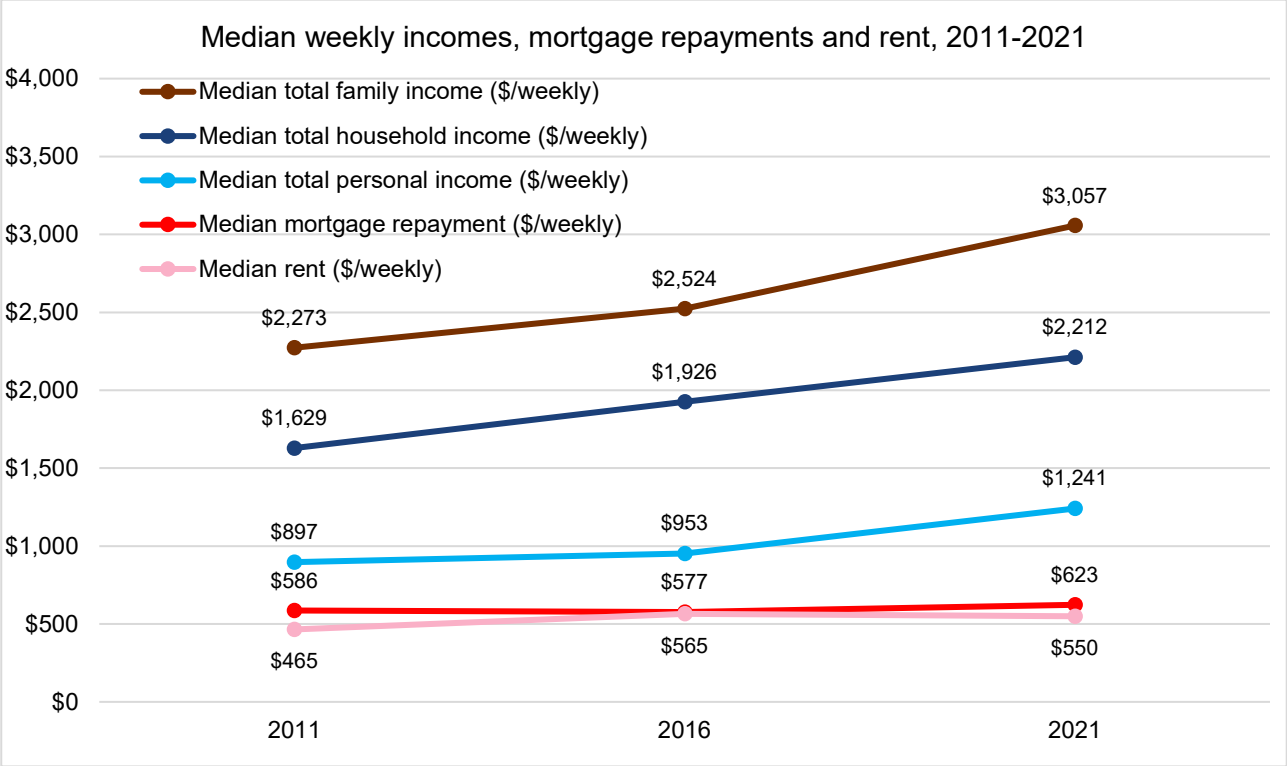


Figure 4. Median weekly incomes, mortgage repayments and rent, 2011-2021. Source: *ABS Census of Population and Housing, 2011, 2016, 2021*

Over the past decade the median personal (38.4%), family (34.5%) and household (35.8%) incomes have risen at a faster rate than median weekly rent (18.3%) and median mortgage repayments (6.3%). Both the median total family income and median total personal income have grown at a faster rate between 2016 and 2021 when compared to the previous five-year period, due to the decline in lower income residents (such as international students) raising the income average for these groups.

Table 5. Proportion of landlord type, City of Sydney, ABS Census 2011-2021

	2011%	2016%	2021%
Fully owned	14.4%	14.5%	14.3%
Mortgage	23.5%	20.3%	19.3%
Renting - Total	60.5%	63.5%	65.1%
Renting - Social housing	9.9%	9.2%	7.3%
Renting - Private	50.2%	54.0%	57.6%
Renting - Not stated	0.4%	0.3%	0.2%
Other tenure type	1.6%	1.8%	1.4%

Table 5 shows the proportions of occupied private dwellings (households) by landlord type for the past three Censuses with the “not stated” category removed. The proportion of occupied private dwellings that are fully owned has remained stable over the past decade, whilst the proportion of households living in their own home with a mortgage has declined.

There has been a commensurate rise in the proportion of households living in private rental dwellings. The proportion of households renting social housing has decreased, whilst the number of social housing dwellings has remained relatively stable over the past decade – they have not risen at the rate of private residential development.

Further information

Additional information relating to residential activity in the City of Sydney local area can be found in the Residential Monitor at:

https://www.cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au/surveys-case-studies-reports/city-monitor-reports

Information relating to City of Sydney local area residents from the 2021 Census and forecasts of future residential growth can be found at the following link:

https://www.cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au/council-governance-administration/community-profile

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